

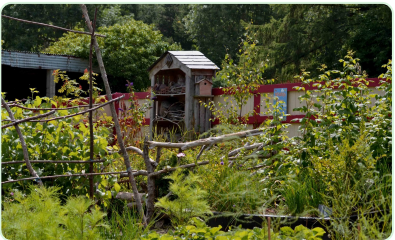
Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in Dublin, Ireland



The Good Grub Initiative
<https://www.goodgrub.ie/>



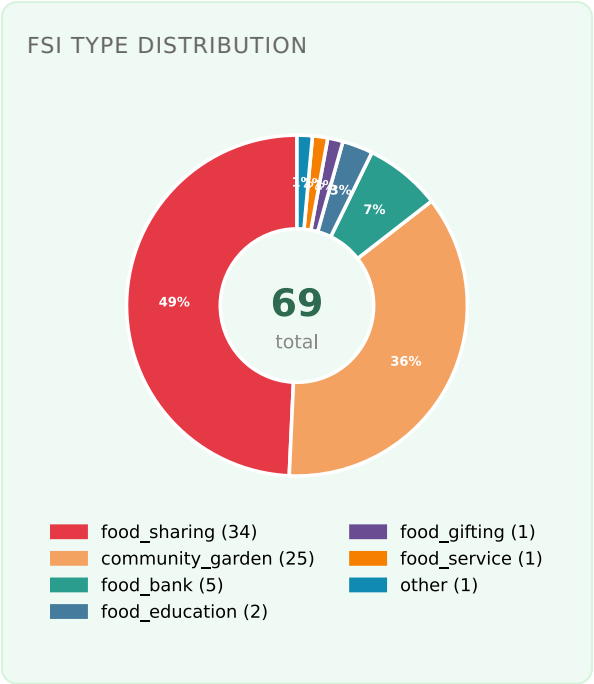
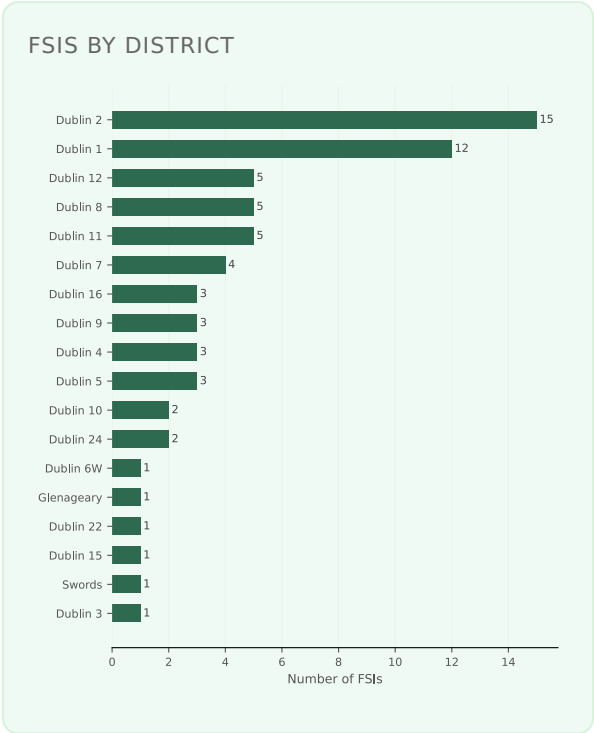
Trinity Care
<https://www.trinitycommunitycare.ie/>



The Importance of School Gardens as a Community
<https://cgireland.org/the-importance-of-school-garden-as-a-community>



Friends of the Elderly Ireland - Bringing friendships and social connections to older adults.
<https://friendsoftheelderly.ie/>



Geographic Distribution

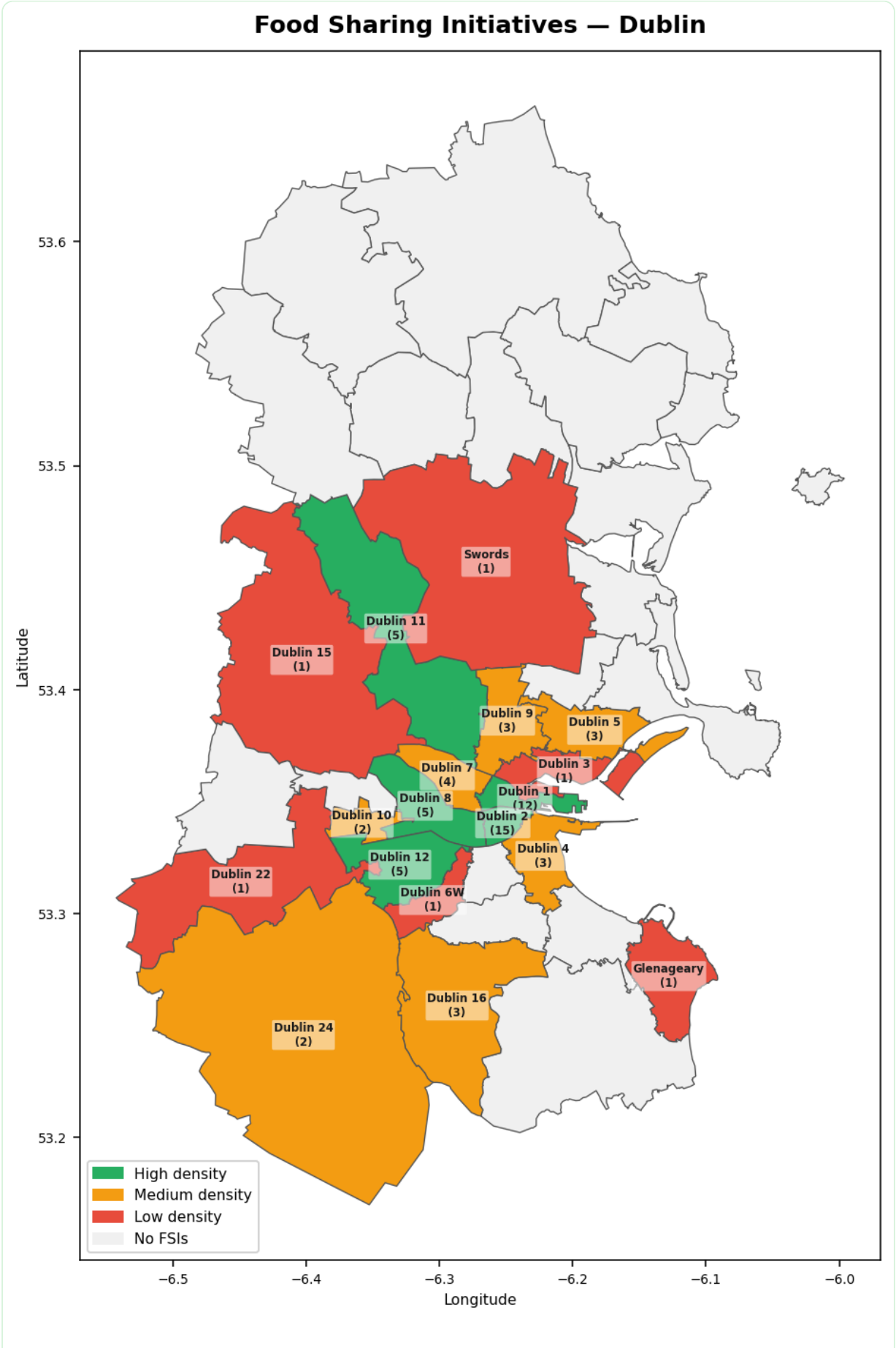


Figure: Food Sharing Initiative locations across Dublin. Districts coloured by FSI density: green = high, yellow = medium, red = low.

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) across 18 postal districts, with the highest concentration found in Dublin 2, which alone accounts for 15 FSIs, followed by Dublin 1 (12) and Dublin 12 (5). These three districts represent the top 3 in terms of FSI density, reflecting a clear geographic clustering in central and western areas. Green (high-density) districts, including Dublin 2, Dublin 1, and Dublin 12, collectively host 37 FSIs, or 54% of the total, while red (low-density) districts—such as Dublin 6W, Glenageary, and Swords—each contain only one FSI, highlighting stark disparities in initiative distribution. The data underscores a pattern where urban centers and historically affluent neighborhoods dominate FSI presence, whereas peripheral and less densely populated areas remain underrepresented.

Yellow (medium-density) districts, such as Dublin 7 and Dublin 16, host 4 and 3 FSIs respectively, occupying a middle ground between high- and low-density areas. Notably, Dublin 8 and Dublin 11, both classified as green districts, each have 5 FSIs, suggesting that even within high-density zones, some areas exhibit lower FSI counts compared to Dublin 2 and Dublin 1. The absence of per capita FSI density data limits deeper analysis of equity in access, but the stark contrast between districts with 15 FSIs and those with only 1 implies uneven resource allocation or differing community engagement levels. For example, Dublin 2's 15 FSIs, the highest in any district, may reflect a combination of population density, organizational infrastructure, and historical investment in food-sharing programs, whereas low-count districts may lack the critical mass or funding to sustain multiple initiatives.

Types of Food Sharing Initiatives

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with food_sharing initiatives comprising 34 (49.3%), the largest category, followed by community_garden initiatives at 25 (36.2%). Food_bank initiatives account for 5 (7.2%), while food_education and food_gifting initiatives each represent 2.9% and 1.4% respectively. Over half (33) of these initiatives emphasize sustainability, and 31 incorporate educational components, highlighting a strong alignment with environmental and learning objectives. Notably, 37 FSIs organize events or workshops, suggesting a focus on community engagement and skill-building activities.

Food_sharing initiatives, though numerically dominant, coexist with community_garden programs, which are slightly less prevalent but still significant. Food_bank initiatives, though fewer in number, likely serve critical roles in addressing immediate food insecurity, as indicated by their distinct category. The presence of 37 FSIs organizing events or workshops contrasts with the minimal representation of food_education (2) and food_gifting (1) initiatives, suggesting that while educational and gifting models exist, they are not as widely adopted. This disparity may reflect differing community needs or resource allocations, with food_sharing and community_garden models better aligned with local priorities. The overlap between sustainability (33) and educational (31) initiatives further

underscores a strategic emphasis on long-term impact and knowledge dissemination within Dublin's FSI landscape.

Operational and Funding Models

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), with 46 being community-led (grassroots) and the remaining 23 supported by government or local councils. Notably, no FSIs are NGO-led or operated as commercial or social enterprises, and all 69 are non-commercial, relying on voluntary or charitable efforts. Of these, 15 FSIs mention crowdfunding or donations as a funding source, while 22 are volunteer-based, highlighting the reliance on grassroots participation. Government-funded initiatives account for 10, and 7 are council-supported, but these represent a minority compared to the community-led majority, underscoring the decentralized nature of food sharing in the city.

Community-led FSIs dominate, but only 13 are formally registered as NGOs or charities, while 21 operate informally through community groups, suggesting varying levels of institutional recognition. Among the community-led initiatives, 7 employ a cooperative model, potentially reflecting more structured collaboration compared to the 21 informal groups. Only 3 FSIs are affiliated with known food networks, indicating limited integration with broader food system initiatives. The absence of NGO-led or commercial FSIs contrasts with other cities, where such models are more common, and the heavy reliance on volunteer labor (22 initiatives) may pose sustainability challenges. These patterns reveal a strong grassroots foundation but also highlight potential gaps in formal support and scalability.

Reach and Activity

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs), categorized into 22 high-activity, 20 medium-activity, and 27 low-activity groups, reflecting a broad spectrum of engagement levels. The total quantified volume of food shared across these initiatives amounts to 1,718 units, encompassing meals, kilograms of food, and member participation. Notably, 28 FSIs collaborate with farms, restaurants, or stores, indicating a significant portion of initiatives integrate with local food production and distribution networks. This collaboration suggests a strategic alignment with existing food systems to enhance resource efficiency and reduce waste.

Among target audiences, initiatives addressing the elderly (43) and general public (42) are the most frequently cited, highlighting a focus on broad community access. In contrast, fewer FSIs explicitly target low-income populations (7) or children (19), suggesting potential gaps in addressing specific vulnerable groups. High-activity FSIs, such as community gardens and cooperatives, often engage in regular workshops and partnerships, aligning with their reported emphasis on education and sustainability. Meanwhile, lower-activity initiatives may lack consistent programming or outreach, as indicated by their smaller audience reach. These disparities underscore the need for targeted support to ensure equitable food access across demographic groups.

Digital Presence and Accessibility

All 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in Dublin maintain a digital presence, as evidenced by website data, indicating a strong reliance on online platforms for communication and coordination. Of these, 27 FSIs explicitly mention online or digital coordination methods, suggesting a subset prioritizes virtual engagement, while 39 operate from physical locations, highlighting the coexistence of hybrid models. Only 4 FSIs provide detailed operating hours or frequency information, a minimal proportion that may limit transparency for potential participants. The absence of consistent accessibility features across FSI websites represents a significant data gap, potentially excluding individuals with disabilities or limited digital literacy from accessing these initiatives.

Comparing sub-groups, FSIs with online coordination (27) may cater to broader audiences through virtual platforms, whereas those relying solely on physical locations (39) might serve more localized communities. The lack of operating hours details for 94% of FSIs (65 out of 69) could hinder participation for individuals requiring predictable schedules, such as students or shift workers. Notably, the absence of standardized accessibility information across websites implies uneven support for diverse user needs, despite all FSIs having digital presence. This contrast between digital availability and functional accessibility underscores a critical challenge in ensuring equitable access to food sharing resources in Dublin.

Notable Initiatives

Dublin hosts 69 Food Sharing Initiatives (FSIs) in total, with the highest concentrations located in Dublin 2 (15 FSIs), Dublin 1 (12 FSIs), and Dublin 12 (5 FSIs). These districts collectively account for 32 of the 69 FSIs, highlighting a regional imbalance in distribution. Notably, 22 FSIs are classified as high-popularity, suggesting significant community engagement, while 31 incorporate educational components, indicating a focus on awareness or skill-building. Additionally, 37 FSIs actively organize events, underscoring the role of community gatherings in fostering participation and visibility.

Among the sub-groups, districts with higher FSI counts, such as Dublin 2, show a greater overlap between event-organizing and educational FSIs, with 15 FSIs in Dublin 2 likely contributing to both categories. In contrast, districts with fewer FSIs, like Dublin 12, may lack the critical mass to sustain event-based or educational programs. For instance, 31 FSIs with educational components may include initiatives that integrate workshops or training, whereas 37 event-organizing FSIs might prioritize outreach through meals or gatherings. This contrast suggests that densely populated areas can support more diverse FSI models, while sparsely populated districts may focus on narrower functions. The data also reveals that 22 high-popularity FSIs may benefit from localized networks or partnerships, enhancing their reach compared to less prominent counterparts.